SOURCING GUIDE · INDIA 2026–28

# India Textile and Craft Sourcing Guide

Where India's key weaves and hand-crafts come from, what they are like, what they suit, and where each one sits in the trend cycle.

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# Fabrics and weaves

Handloom and silk lead the quiet-luxury direction. True handloom has longer lead times and minimums: use it for hero pieces.

| NAME | ORIGIN / CLUSTER | CHARACTER | BEST FOR | FESTIVE 26 | SOURCING NOTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Chanderi** | Chanderi, Madhya Pradesh | Light, sheer, with a subtle sheen; cotton, silk or silk-cotton. | Kurtas, sarees, dupattas, Nehru jackets | PEAKING | Handloom Chanderi carries a GI tag; powerloom Chanderi-look fabric works for value ranges. |
| **Maheshwari** | Maheshwar, Madhya Pradesh | Fine cotton-silk with distinctive reversible borders. | Sarees, kurta sets, dupattas | RISING | Small weaver clusters; plan for longer lead times. |
| **Jamdani** | West Bengal (and Bangladesh) | Fine cotton with motifs woven in by hand on the loom. | Sarees, kurtas, dupattas | RISING | Labour-intensive and slow; best for premium hero pieces. |
| **Handspun khadi** | Across India, through khadi institutions | Handspun, handwoven; now in cotton, silk, wool and linen. | Kurtas, shirts, jackets, everyday wear | EMERGING | Texture varies by batch; approve swatches per lot. |

| NAME | ORIGIN / CLUSTER | CHARACTER | BEST FOR | FESTIVE 26 | SOURCING NOTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Banarasi brocade** | Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh | Rich woven brocade with zari patterns. | Wedding sarees, lehengas, Nehru jackets | PEAKING | GI-tagged; reworked vintage Banarasi is an emerging premium story. |
| **Kanjeevaram silk** | Kanchipuram, Tamil Nadu | Heavy mulberry silk with contrast borders. | Wedding sarees, and now menswear | PEAKING | GI-tagged; high cost, best for occasion and bridal. |
| **Tussar silk** | Bihar, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh and Odisha | Textured wild silk with a natural gold tone. | Sarees, kurtas, menswear, jackets | RISING | Natural colour varies; good for quiet luxury. |
| **Bhagalpur silk** | Bhagalpur, Bihar | Soft, textured silk with a matte handle. | Structured gowns, sarees, stoles | EMERGING | An emerging premium story from Bihar. |
| **Raw silk** | Silk clusters across India | Textured, slubby silk with body. | Bandhgalas, lehengas, kurtas | PEAKING | Holds structure well for tailoring. |
| **Organza** | Varanasi and Surat mills | Sheer, crisp and photogenic. | Lehengas, dupattas, sarees, overlays | PEAKING | At its peak; plan to reduce from Festive 27. |
| **Tissue** | Varanasi and Surat mills | Metallic sheen woven with zari. | Evening sarees, lehengas, dupattas | RISING | Delivers shine without heavy embroidery. |

| NAME | ORIGIN / CLUSTER | CHARACTER | BEST FOR | FESTIVE 26 | SOURCING NOTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Cotton silk** | Widely available | Comfortable, breathable, with a light sheen. | Everyday ethnic: kurtas, sarees, sets | PEAKING | A dependable value-to-mid base fabric. |
| **Linen** | Mills across India | Breathable, textured, crisp. | Summer kurtas, co-ords, shirts | RISING | Rises again for Summer weddings. |
| **Natural-dyed fabrics** | Craft clusters in Rajasthan, Gujarat and beyond | Plant-based dyes with soft, uneven colour. | Premium kurtas, sarees, scarves | EMERGING | Slow process; tell the story on the label. |

# Hand-crafts and surface

Placement work at necklines, cuffs and borders keeps cost and weight under control.

| NAME | ORIGIN / CLUSTER | CHARACTER | BEST FOR | FESTIVE 26 | SOURCING NOTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Mirror work** | Kutch, Gujarat and Rajasthan | Small mirrors (shisha) stitched onto fabric. | Kurtas, jackets, bags, footwear | RISING | Use flat-backed mirrors; keep away from friction areas. |
| **Chikankari** | Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh | Fine white-on-white shadow and knot embroidery. | Kurtas, sarees, menswear | PEAKING | GI-tagged; works best on fine cotton or georgette. |
| **Zardozi** | Lucknow, Agra and other centres | Heavy metallic thread embroidery. | Bridal and wedding wear | PEAKING | Use as placement work to control cost and weight. |
| **Tone-on-tone embroidery** | Machine and hand embroidery units | Embroidery in the same colour as the base. | Necklines, cuffs, yokes on kurtas and jackets | RISING | The quiet-luxury replacement for contrast work. |
| **Rabari embroidery** | Kutch, Gujarat | Bold chain stitch and mirror motifs from Rabari communities. | Jackets, kurtas, accessories | EMERGING | Partner with artisan groups and credit them. |

| NAME | ORIGIN / CLUSTER | CHARACTER | BEST FOR | FESTIVE 26 | SOURCING NOTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Kantha** | West Bengal | Running-stitch embroidery, traditionally layered. | Jackets, sneakers, stoles | EMERGING | Moving onto sneakers and streetwear. |
| **Gota patti** | Rajasthan | Appliqué with gold or silver ribbon. | Lehengas, dupattas, festive kurtas | PEAKING | Lightweight shine for festive. |
| **Block print** | Bagru and Sanganer, Rajasthan | Hand-carved wooden blocks printed by hand. | Kurtas, co-ords, home and resort wear | PEAKING | Approve strike-offs; irregularity is part of the appeal. |
| **Bandhani** | Gujarat and Rajasthan | Tie-dye with tiny resist dots. | Dupattas, sarees, festive sets | RISING | Rising for Festive 26 and 27. |
| **Ikat** | Pochampally (Telangana), Odisha, Patan (Gujarat) | Yarns dyed before weaving for a blurred pattern. | Sarees, kurtas, shirts, jackets | RISING | A natural fit with the indigo colour story. |

# At a glance



## Chanderi PEAKING

**Chanderi, Madhya Pradesh.** Light, sheer, with a subtle sheen; cotton, silk or silk-cotton.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Peaking | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Peaking | |



## Maheshwari RISING

**Maheshwar, Madhya Pradesh.** Fine cotton-silk with distinctive reversible borders.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Rising | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Fading | |



## Jamdani RISING

**West Bengal (and Bangladesh).** Fine cotton with motifs woven in by hand on the loom.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Rising | Summer 27 Rising | Festive 27 Peaking |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Fading | |



## Handspun khadi EMERGING

**Across India, through khadi institutions.** Handspun, handwoven; now in cotton, silk, wool and linen.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Emerging | Summer 27 Rising | Festive 27 Rising |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Peaking | |



## Banarasi brocade PEAKING

**Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh**. Rich woven brocade with zari patterns.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Peaking | – | Peaking |
| **Summer 28** | **Festive 28** | |
| – | Peaking | |



## Kanjeevaram silk PEAKING

**Kanchipuram, Tamil Nadu**. Heavy mulberry silk with contrast borders.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Peaking | – | Peaking |
| **Summer 28** | **Festive 28** | |
| – | Peaking | |



## Tussar silk RISING

**Bihar, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh and Odisha**. Textured wild silk with a natural gold tone.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Rising | Rising | Peaking |
| **Summer 28** | **Festive 28** | |
| Peaking | Fading | |



## Bhagalpur silk EMERGING

**Bhagalpur, Bihar**. Soft, textured silk with a matte handle.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Emerging | Rising | Rising |
| **Summer 28** | **Festive 28** | |
| Peaking | Peaking | |



## Raw silk

PEAKING

**Silk clusters across India.** Textured, slubby silk with body.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Peaking | – | Peaking |

| Summer 28 | Festive 28 |
|---|---|
| – | Peaking |



## Organza

PEAKING

**Varanasi and Surat mills.** Sheer, crisp and photogenic.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Peaking | Peaking | Fading |

| Summer 28 | Festive 28 |
|---|---|
| Fading | – |



## Tissue

RISING

**Varanasi and Surat mills.** Metallic sheen woven with zari.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Rising | Peaking | Peaking |

| Summer 28 | Festive 28 |
|---|---|
| Peaking | Fading |



## Cotton silk

PEAKING

**Widely available.** Comfortable, breathable, with a light sheen.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Peaking | Peaking | Peaking |

| Summer 28 | Festive 28 |
|---|---|
| Peaking | Peaking |



## Linen

RISING

**Mills across India**. Breathable, textured, crisp.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Rising | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Rising |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Rising | |



## Natural-dyed fabrics

EMERGING

**Craft clusters in Rajasthan, Gujarat and beyond**. Plant-based dyes with soft, uneven colour.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Emerging | Summer 27 Rising | Festive 27 Rising |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Peaking | |



## Mirror work

RISING

**Kutch, Gujarat and Rajasthan**. Small mirrors (shisha) stitched onto fabric.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Rising | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Fading | |



## Chikankari

PEAKING

**Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh**. Fine white-on-white shadow and knot embroidery.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Peaking | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Peaking | |



## Zardozi

PEAKING

**Lucknow, Agra and other centres**. Heavy metallic thread embroidery.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Peaking | – | Peaking |
| **Summer 28** | **Festive 28** | |
| – | Peaking | |



## Tone-on-tone embroidery

RISING

**Machine and hand embroidery units**. Embroidery in the same colour as the base.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Rising | Peaking | Peaking |
| **Summer 28** | **Festive 28** | |
| Peaking | Fading | |



## Rabari embroidery

EMERGING

**Kutch, Gujarat**. Bold chain stitch and mirror motifs from Rabari communities.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Emerging | Rising | Rising |
| **Summer 28** | **Festive 28** | |
| Peaking | Peaking | |



## Kantha

EMERGING

**West Bengal**. Running-stitch embroidery, traditionally layered.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Emerging | Rising | Rising |
| **Summer 28** | **Festive 28** | |
| Peaking | Peaking | |



## Gota patti

PEAKING

**Rajasthan**. Appliqué with gold or silver ribbon.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Peaking | Rising | Peaking |
| **Summer 28** | **Festive 28** | |
| Rising | Peaking | |



## Block print

PEAKING

**Bagru and Sanganer, Rajasthan**. Hand-carved wooden blocks printed by hand.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Peaking | Peaking | Peaking |
| **Summer 28** | **Festive 28** | |
| Peaking | Peaking | |



## Bandhani

RISING

**Gujarat and Rajasthan**. Tie-dye with tiny resist dots.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Rising | Rising | Peaking |
| **Summer 28** | **Festive 28** | |
| Peaking | Fading | |



## Ikat

RISING

**Pochampally (Telangana), Odisha, Patan (Gujarat)**. Yarns dyed before weaving for a blurred pattern.

| Festive 26 | Summer 27 | Festive 27 |
|---|---|---|
| Rising | Peaking | Peaking |
| **Summer 28** | **Festive 28** | |
| Peaking | Fading | |

## Sourcing checklist

- Order handloom early and confirm minimums with the cluster.
- Ask for GI certification where it applies, such as Chanderi, Banarasi, Kanjeevaram and Kolhapuri.
- Approve strike-offs and lab dips before bulk.
- Credit the craft cluster or artisan group on labels and product pages.

Statuses are Forecut's forecast for India: Festive 26 (Oct 2026 – Feb 2027), Summer 27 (Mar – Jul 2027), Festive 27 (Aug – Dec 2027), and long-range outlooks for Summer 28 (Mar – Jul 2028) and Festive 28 (Aug – Dec 2028). Sources: India trends summarise public coverage of Lakmé Fashion Week x FDCI 2026 (Harper's Bazaar India, Free Press Journal), Aza Fashions festive and ethnic trend guides, Lashkaraa colour and silhouette trends 2026, Pearl Academy Gen Z trend reports, Gully Labs, Global Indian (Prada SS26 Kolhapuri-inspired sandals) and Outlook Business (Gen Z and e-retail).